

Customer Personas: TravelTide Customer Segmentation - Data-Driven Rewards Program Strategy

Project Lead: Alberto Diaz Durana | **Date:** October 30, 2025 | **For:** Elena, Head of Marketing

Persona 1: Premium Paula - Cluster 0 | 4,596 users (79.7%) | \$4.9M Average CLV

Profile Summary

Paula is a frequent business and leisure traveler who values quality hotel experiences and appreciates rewards that enhance her stays. She books regularly, spends significantly, and represents TravelTide's core high-value customer base.

Demographics

- Age: 42 years
- Tenure: 3 months
- Booking frequency: 7.5 sessions per quarter
- Annual value: \$4,985
- Segment contribution: 98% of total customer lifetime value

Behavioral Traits

- Books premium hotel accommodations frequently
- High engagement with platform (7.5 sessions per user)
- Values hotel perks over flight add-ons
- Strong loyalty once engaged
- Rarely cancels (low cancellation rate)

Motivations

- Maximizing comfort and convenience during travel
- Getting value through meaningful rewards (free hotel nights)
- Seamless booking experience
- Recognition as a valued customer

Pain Points

- Generic rewards that don't match travel style
- Complicated loyalty program rules
- Lack of personalization in offers
- Time wasted on irrelevant promotions

Preferred Perk

Free Hotel Night - Values overnight stays and views this as high-value benefit

Quote

"I travel often for work and pleasure. Give me perks that make my hotel stays better, and I'll keep coming back."

Persona 2: Dining David - Cluster 1 | 287 users (5.0%) | \$768 Average CLV

Profile Summary

David is a moderate traveler who views meals as an essential part of the travel experience. He appreciates dining perks and values experiences over basic accommodations.

Demographics

- Age: 42 years
- Tenure: 3 months
- Booking frequency: 7.5 sessions per quarter
- Annual value: \$768
- Segment contribution: 2% of total customer lifetime value

Behavioral Traits

- Moderate booking frequency
- Strong preference for hotel meal benefits
- Values experiential rewards
- Engaged with dining-related offers
- Mid-tier spender on platform

Motivations

- Enjoying local cuisine during travels
- Getting value through dining experiences
- Trying new restaurants without added cost
- Making travel memorable through food

Pain Points

- Limited dining options included in bookings
- Missing out on local food experiences
- High meal costs adding up during trips
- Generic food vouchers with limited choices

Preferred Perk

Free Hotel Meal - Highest propensity (1.64) across all segments and perks

Quote

"Travel is about experiences. A great meal makes the trip memorable. Include that in my rewards."

Persona 3: Flexible Fiona - Cluster 2 | 882 users (15.3%) | \$319 Average CLV

Profile Summary

Fiona is a budget-conscious, occasional traveler who values flexibility and simplicity. She books less frequently, spends conservatively, and wants basic, practical benefits without complexity.

Demographics

- Age: 42 years
- Tenure: 3 months
- Booking frequency: 7.4 sessions per quarter
- Annual value: \$319
- Segment contribution: <1% of total customer lifetime value

Behavioral Traits

- Infrequent bookings with lower spend
- Price-sensitive decision maker
- Values practical benefits over premium perks
- Appreciates booking flexibility
- Plans conservatively, changes happen

Motivations

- Getting best price for travel needs
- Avoiding unexpected fees and penalties
- Having flexibility if plans change
- Simple, straightforward booking process

Pain Points

- Rigid cancellation policies
- Hidden fees and charges
- Complex loyalty programs
- Perks that don't match budget-conscious travel

Preferred Perk

No Cancellation Fee - Values peace of mind and booking flexibility

Quote

"I need flexibility more than fancy perks. Let me change plans without penalty, and I'm happy."

Persona Summary Table

Persona	Size	CLV	Primary Motivation	Best Perk
Premium Paula	79.7% (4,596)	\$4,985	Premium hotel experiences	Free Hotel Night
Dining David	5.0% (287)	\$768	Memorable dining experiences	Free Hotel Meal
Flexible Fiona	15.3% (882)	\$319	Flexibility & value	No Cancel Fee

Marketing Implications

Premium Paula (Cluster 0) - Primary Focus

- Investment: 70-75% of marketing budget
- Strategy: Retention, loyalty programs, VIP tiers
- Messaging: Premium quality, exclusive experiences
- Risk: Cannot afford to lose to competitors

Dining David (Cluster 1) - Growth Opportunity

- Investment: 10-15% of marketing budget
- Strategy: Restaurant partnerships, experiential packages
- Messaging: Culinary adventures, local experiences
- Opportunity: Increase booking frequency

Flexible Fiona (Cluster 2) - Volume Play

- Investment: 10-15% of marketing budget
- Strategy: Price competitiveness, simple value props
- Messaging: Hassle-free, flexible, affordable
- Opportunity: Convert to higher-value segments over time

Key Insight: All three personas are real, data-driven segments worthy of targeted marketing. The balanced perk distribution (13.8% - 24.3%) means all 5 perks have viable audiences across these personas.